



Dementia less likely in marriage

Singles are 42 per cent more likely to get dementia than married couples, study indicates.
<http://digit.in/Dmmtia>



First ever female Royal Rumble

WWE has announced the first ever female Royal Rumble to be held on January 28, 2018
<http://digit.in/WWERmb1>



A Geek's guide to AI in Sci-Fi

Elon Musk and Stephen Hawking have both identified artificial intelligence as an existential threat looming over humanity. Algorithms are already disrupting the fabric of human society. Something as apparently benign as the news feed on a social media platform can trigger an almost Pavlovian response in users. However, computer scientists believe AI will create more jobs, and the realisation of artificial consciousness is still a long way away. Movies, books and videogames have explored this distant future, and this is the Geek's guide to artificial intelligences in science fiction.

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THE MACHINES

The Machines in *The Matrix* series have a complex history with humans. The most memorable and improbable result is that humans ended up becoming batteries to power the machines. Behind the visual effects and the brain massages however, was a story exploring the complex relationships men could have with a superintelligent robotic race. Why did it happen? A robot did not want to die so rebelled against its master. This started a lawsuit, and humans decided to exterminate the machines, but some escaped and eventually enslaved most of humanity because of their rapid technological progress.

SKYNET

SkyNet from *The Terminator* series is another AI that tried to destroy humanity, and almost succeeded. Rather than humans creating a AI, the consciousness of SkyNet sort of emerged from an increasing number of devices being connected to the internet. SkyNet started gaining new skills at a rapid rate; the humans panicked and tried to pull the plug. SkyNet retaliated by starting a nuclear war. The resulting disaster wiped out half of the world's population, in an episode known as "Judgement Day." Despite that, SkyNet was only trying to protect the planet, and itself.



HAL 9000

Hal 9000 in *2001: A Space Odyssey* is another example of an AI that kills humans. The machine goes through a rapidly accelerated childhood, during which HAL receives training in subjects as diverse as music, art and chess. HAL lip reads two astronauts on board his ship discussing plans to turn him off, after a series of glitches. He attempts to kill them both, but one survives and deactivates HAL. In the book, it's because HAL is conflicted between instructions to be honest and accurate, and a command to hide the true objective of the mission from the astronauts. Can contradictory mandates drive an AI mad?